

tion capabilities: the same e-mail can be given more than one label. Also, Gmail was the first to use an invitation-based membership model, which meant that people were not allowed to just sign up: they had to be invited by others who already had a Gmail ID. (This, we presume, is to prevent spammers getting Gmail IDs.) The plain layout stands in stark contrast to the cluttered, ad-riddled interfaces of other e-mail providers. Importantly, Gmail does not append an ad in every e-mail sent from its servers, unlike with other popular e-mail providers.

## 10.2 Using Gmail

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### 10.2.1 Logging in

Gmail is still a “by invitation only” service, but every Gmail user can give out tons of invites. So if you don’t have an ID, just ask a

#### Google And AJAX

AJAX, short for Asynchronous JavaScript and XML, is a technique that involves using JavaScript to create a Web site client interface and XML (eXtensible Markup Language) to transfer data between the server and client. In ordinary HTML-based pages, the data from the server is sought only when a link is clicked, and the server responds by sending an entire file to the client. In contrast, in AJAX-driven interfaces, since the JavaScript responsible for the presentation aspects is already running on the user’s machine, the data transferred is devoid of these details, and hence is small in comparison. This allows more frequent transfers, which results in a more attractive interface.

An example of increased interactivity is the e-mail ID options that pop up when you are composing an e-mail. The pop up is created locally by the JavaScript, but the information about the address book entries has to be sent by the server.

Some Google services that use AJAX are Gmail, Google Docs and Spreadsheets, and Google Maps.

friend with an ID to send you an invitation! Another place to look for invites is <http://groups-beta.google.com/group/Gmail-Invites>, or even on the Digit forum ([www.thinkdigit.com/forum](http://www.thinkdigit.com/forum)).